

OMB Control No: 0970-0114

Expiration date: 03/31/2027

THE PAPERWORK REDUCTION ACT OF 1995 (Pub. L. 104–13)

The purpose of this information collection is the application for CCDF funds and provides ACF and the public with a description of, and assurance about, the States' and Territories' child care programs. Public reporting burden for this collection of information is estimated to average 150 hours per response, including the time for reviewing instructions, gathering, and maintaining the data needed, and completing the form. This is a mandatory collection of information (Pub. L. 113–186), and 42 U.S.C. 9858.

An agency may not conduct or sponsor, and a person is not required to respond to, a collection of information subject to the requirements of the Paperwork Reduction Act of 1995, unless it displays a currently valid OMB control number. The OMB # is 0970-0114 and the expiration date is 03/31/2027. If you have any comments on this collection of information, please contact ACF's Office of Child Care.



**Appendix 1: Lead Agency Implementation Plan
for**

State/Territory Connecticut

FFY 2025 – 2027

Version: Initial Plan

Plan Status: Approved as of 2024-11-09 00:16:04 GMT

For each non-compliance, Lead Agencies must describe the following:

- **Action Steps:** List the action steps needed to correct the finding (e.g., update policy manual, legislative approval, IT system changes, etc.). For each action step list the:
 - o **Expected Completion Date:** List the expected completion date for the action step.
- **Overall Target Date for Compliance:** List date Lead Agency anticipates completing implementation, achieving full compliance with all aspects of the findings. (Note: Compliance will not be determined until the FFY 2025-2027 CCDF Plan is amended and approved).

EQUAL ACCESS:AFFORDABILITY

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not limit all family co-payments to seven percent or less of family income, as required by 98.45(l)(3). (Plan Question 3.1.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 01/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The OEC is awaiting OCC review and approval of amendment indicating compliance.	01/01/2025

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT PRACTICES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not pay all provider types prospectively or alternatively does not demonstrate that it is not a generally-accepted practice for all provider types, as required by 98.45(m)(1). (Plan Question 4.4.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 03/30/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	July 1, 2024, Connecticut Public Act No. 24-91 repealed the regulations that governed the Care 4 Kids child care subsidy program. P.A. No. 24-91 further directed the Commissioner of the OEC to implement the provisions of 45 CFR 98 in order to administer the child care program and to develop policies and procedures necessary to implement such program.	09/30/2024

	Create a framework for policy manual that aligns with Federal Rules.	
2	Apply for ASSIST Technical Assistant support from the National Center for Subsidy Innovation and Accountability to develop and implement C4K policy manual.	10/16/2024
3	Hold three state-wide listening session with parent and providers to identify changes to C4K program. Use feedback to inform policy manual changes.	01/02/2025
4	OEC Policy team with support of ASSIST TA staff will draft C4K Policy Manual. OEC Policy team consults with OEC Leadership for feedback and edits OEC Policy team works with C4K team on the development of business processes related to revised policy. OEC consults with Deloitte IT team for policy changes that would require IT system updates.	10/30/2025
5	Begin phased-in rollout of C4K policy changes including paying provider prospectively. Update IT system based on policy changes. Develop and implement a communication plan with support from communication contractor at OEC. Pay all providers prospectively.	03/30/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT RATES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency's payment rates for preschoolers in center-based care, preschoolers in family child care homes, and infants in center-based care are not sufficient to ensure equal access, as required by 98.45(a). (Plan Question 4.3.2a)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/01/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	OEC has requested for Office of Policy and Management State funds that will assist in bringing the payment for all provider types to at least 50th percentile of the current market rate.	11/01/2024
2	The State budget approved including rate increase for all provider types to 50th percentile of the market rate.	06/01/2025
3	Rate increase updated in ImpaCT Eligibility system.	06/30/2025
4	Rate increase effective and all new and redetermined certificates issue to families and providers.	07/01/2025

EQUAL ACCESS:PROVIDER OPTIONS FOR PARENTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide grants or contracts for direct services for infants and toddlers, for children in underserved geographic areas, and for children with disabilities, as required by 98.30(b)(1). (Plan Questions 4.1.1c and 4.5.1i). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through August 1, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 01/01/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	CCDF Team will work with Social Finance business consultants and OEC's Early Care and Education team to develop a 3-5 year CCDF strategic plan which will include all new federal rule changes including development of a contracting pilot for direct services for an identified populations in the federal rule. The pilot will support the OEC's vision to integrate all state and	05/30/2025

	federal funding streams to create one point of entry for families.	
2	CCDF team will work with Deloitte, IT consultants, to complete any system changes to support contracting pilot.	06/30/2025
3	Select eligible child care providers to participate in contracting pilot.	08/30/2025
4	Train selected provider on CCDF rules and contract requirements.	10/30/2025
5	Contracts executed.	01/30/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:SUPPLY BUILDING STRATEGIES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not adequately describe strategies to improve the supply and quality of child care during non-traditional hours, as required by 98.16(y) and (aa). (Plan Question 4.5.4d)

Overall Target Completion Date: 07/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The OEC, Data Scientist will draft a child care needs assessment study. The study will include data and analysis of the supply and demand of nontraditional hours of care providers.	03/30/2025
2	The data from the study will be used to identify strategies to increase the supply of nontraditional hour care.	04/30/2025
3	The CCDF Policy team will work with other OEC team leads in other divisions who oversee projects related to child care supply building. Three promising projects in development:	05/30/2025

	Tri-Share Child Care ☐ Program establish through Connecticut's House Bill 5002. Pilot will focus on large employer in the New London area. The program is employer, state and employee fund matching program to lower the child care cost for employees. An additional program focus will include increasing the child care supply for 2nd shift workers. First Responder Referral Process - The enhanced referral service for first responders includes referrals to childcare programs that have been prescreened by 211 Child Care Referral Specialists for availability and the specific needs of families. First responders using this service received detailed program profiles, which include licensing inspection reports, hours, fees, capacity, meals, and special needs experience information for each prescreened program, a parent resource packet, connection to all 211 resources, and a follow-up call to check on outcomes and offer further referrals if needed. Team is tracking the requests for nontraditional hours. Data will be used to help build supply. Staffed Family Child Care Networks ☐ OEC will work closely with SFCCN Hub contractor to support providers interested in expanding business to serve families seeking nontraditional hour of care.	
4	Implement supply building strategy for increasing the supply of nontraditional hours of care.	07/30/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS AND RESPONSE PLANNING

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers and licensed family child care for compliance with standards for emergency preparedness and response planning, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Questions 5.5.1aii and 5.5.1bii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 12/15/2024

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The OEC has submitted a letter disputing the non-compliance for licensed centers.	12/15/2025
2	The OEC has submitted evidence to the regional office for review to determine compliance.	01/02/2025
3	The OEC is awaiting Office of Child Care's review and then will submit an amendment to show compliance.	02/13/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:PREVENTION OF SHAKEN BABY SYNDROME, ABUSIVE HEAD TRAUMA, AND CHILD MALTREATMENT

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for the prevention of shaken baby syndrome and abusive head trauma for licensed centers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(vi). (Plan Question 5.3.6ai)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers for compliance with a standard for prevention of shaken baby syndrome and abusive head trauma, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Question 5.5.1aii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/16/2024

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The OEC is awaiting OCC review and approval of amendment indicating compliance.	10/16/2024